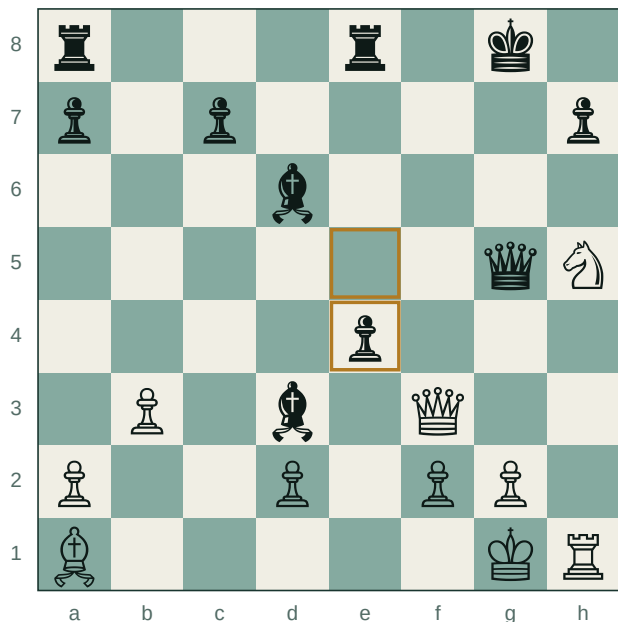


Double checks: White, move 23

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 22...e4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Nf6+ Kf8 24. Nxh7+ Ke7 25. Bf6+ Qxf6 26. Qxf6+

23.Nf6+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on g8 and rook on e8. Recorded reply: **23...Kf8**.

24.Nxh7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From h7 it attacks king on f8 and queen on g5. Recorded reply: **24...Ke7**.

25.Bf6+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on e7 and queen on g5. Recorded reply: **25...Qxf6**.

26.Qxf6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f6 it attacks king on e7 and bishop on d6.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +7:** the balance goes from -4 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on g5. Check for tactical protection.